
GOVERNMENT EDITION

The Acquisition Starter Kit

The field guide nobody hands you on day one. How DoD buys things in 2026, the numbers that come up in every meeting, the acronyms, and the five mistakes that make new program managers famous for the wrong reasons.



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2025 and 2026 moved more than the ten years before them

If a colleague trained you on the "old" way, some of it is now wrong. Here is what moved, what it means for your day job, and where it stood when we checked on **28 September 2026**.

WHAT CHANGED	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU	STATUS
The FAR is being rewritten RFO	The Revolutionary FAR Overhaul is still called the FAR, but many parts have new text and some clauses have new numbers. Before you quote a FAR cite, ask which version your contracting office is using.	DoD adopted the rewritten parts by class deviation, most on Feb 1, 2026. Formal rules: set 1 in June 2026, set 2 on Sept 18 (comments due Oct 19). Two sets still to come.
JCIDS is gone HISTORY	Each service now validates its own requirements. The JROC ranks the joint force's toughest operational problems, and a new board (the RRAB) lines requirements up with money. ICD, CDD and CPD are legacy names you will still hear.	Ended by the Aug 20, 2025 memo.
PEOs become Portfolio Acquisition Executives	The "Warfighting Acquisition System" manages by portfolio, looks at commercial solutions first, and prefers competitive prototypes over long analyses.	Nov 7, 2025 memo. PAEs are rolling out over about two years and are in the FY2026 NDAA.
DAU is now WarU	Defense Acquisition University is now Warfighting Acquisition University. Same mission, new name on your training record.	Renamed November 2025.
Bigger ACAT lines	ACAT I now starts above \$1B RDT&E or \$4.5B procurement, and ACAT II above \$275M or \$1.3B. Fewer programs land in the top categories.	FY2026 NDAA (P.L. 119-60), Dec 2025. Page 5.
Higher buying thresholds	Micro-purchase is \$15,000 and the simplified acquisition threshold is \$350,000.	FAC 2025-06, effective Oct 1, 2025.
TINA and EVM thresholds up	Certified cost or pricing data at \$10M on DoD contracts. EVM from \$50M, a validated EVM system from \$100M.	FY2026 NDAA sec. 1804(c), for contracts after June 30, 2026. DFARS deviation 2026-O0011.
CMMC Phase 2 paused PAUSED	Third-party (C3PAO) certification is not required on new contracts. Contractors still self-assess in SPRS and still owe NIST SP 800-171 under DFARS 252.204-7012.	Suspended July 13, 2026 for a task force review. No new Phase 2 date yet.
"Department of War"	Since September 2025 the department also uses the name Department of War. You will see DoD and DoW on the same page. This guide says DoD.	Executive order, Sept 2025.
FY2027 started on a CR	Under a continuing resolution you can keep paying for what you already had, but new starts and production increases generally wait.	CR signed Sept 2, 2026 (P.L. 119-103), runs to Dec 11, 2026.

HOW TO CHECK WHAT IS CURRENT

FAR text by part lives at [acquisition.gov/far-overhaul](https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul). Your contracting office keeps its own list of adopted deviations. When in doubt, ask your contracting officer "which version applies to this action?" It makes you look careful, not lost.

Three systems that have to agree before anything gets bought

People call it "Big A" acquisition. A program only moves when three separate systems line up: someone has to **need** it, someone has to **pay** for it, and someone has to **buy** it. Most program drama happens where two of them disagree.

DO WE NEED IT?

Requirements

- Each service validates its own requirements (since Aug 2025).
- The JROC ranks the joint force's Key Operational Problems.
- The RRAB lines requirements up with money.
- MEIA runs mission engineering and experiments.
- Output: a validated requirement. Many offices still call it a CDD.

CAN WE PAY FOR IT?

Resources (PPBE)

- Planning, Programming, Budgeting, Execution.
- Services build the POM. OSD adjusts it with Resource Management Decisions (RMDs, once called PBDs).
- The President's Budget goes to Congress, which authorizes (NDAA) and appropriates.
- The money you spend today was planned about two years ago.

HOW DO WE BUY IT?

Acquisition

- DoDI 5000.02, the Adaptive Acquisition Framework: six pathways (page 4).
- Run by program managers under PEOs, which are becoming PAEs.
- A Milestone Decision Authority (MDA) approves the big steps.
- Contracts are awarded and changed only by a warranted contracting officer.

Who does what

ROLE	WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DO
Milestone Decision Authority (MDA)	Approves pathway, milestones and the program baseline. For the biggest programs, USD(A&S) or a service acquisition executive.
Service / Component Acquisition Executive (SAE, CAE)	The senior acquisition official in each service. The Department of the Air Force has a separate one for space.
PEO, becoming PAE	Runs a portfolio of related programs. PAEs get more authority to move money and people across that portfolio.
Program Manager (PM)	Owns cost, schedule and performance for one program. The person everyone calls when something slips.
Contracting Officer (CO or KO)	The only person who can sign, change or end a contract on the government's behalf.
Contracting Officer's Representative (COR)	Watches technical performance day to day. Cannot change the contract, however helpful that would be.
DCMA and DCAA	DCMA oversees contractor performance and administers contracts. DCAA audits contractor costs and accounting.

Pick the right lane before you pick up speed

The Adaptive Acquisition Framework replaced one-size-fits-all with six pathways. The pathway sets your paperwork, your oversight and how fast you can move. The MDA makes the call, but a good PM walks in with a recommendation and a reason.

PATHWAY	USE IT FOR	THE CLOCK	RULES
Urgent Capability Acquisition	Urgent operational needs, usually from a combatant command. Capped below the old ACAT I line (\$525M RDT&E or \$3.065B procurement, FY2020 dollars).	Field within 2 years.	DoDI 5000.81
Middle Tier: rapid prototyping	Proving new capability with prototypes that can be left with users.	Complete in under 5 years.	DoDI 5000.80
Middle Tier: rapid fielding	Getting proven, mature technology into production and the field.	Production starts within 6 months; fielding done within 5 years.	DoDI 5000.80
Major Capability Acquisition	Large, complex systems: ships, aircraft, satellites. Milestones A, B and C (page 5).	GAO's July 2026 average: over 12 years to deliver a capability.	DoDI 5000.85
Software Acquisition	Software-intensive programs using agile and DevSecOps. Since a March 2025 memo it is the preferred pathway for software, with Commercial Solutions Openings and Other Transactions as the default ways to buy.	First release (the MVCR) within 1 year of first obligation, then new capability at least every year. The goal is every 6 months or faster.	DoDI 5000.87
Defense Business Systems	Enterprise IT for finance, HR, logistics and similar business work.	Business Capability Acquisition Cycle.	DoDI 5000.75
Acquisition of Services	Buying services above the simplified acquisition threshold. Oversight grows with value: S-CAT I starts at \$1B.	Planned by a services requirements owner and a senior services manager.	DoDI 5000.74

A quick pathway selector

IF THE HONEST ANSWER IS YES...	START THE CONVERSATION WITH
A combatant command needs it urgently and it can be fielded in about two years	Urgent Capability Acquisition
It is mostly software, or the value is in the code	Software Acquisition
The technology works today and you mainly need to produce and field it	Middle Tier: rapid fielding
You need to prove a concept fast with working prototypes	Middle Tier: rapid prototyping
It is finance, HR or logistics IT for the enterprise	Defense Business Systems
You are buying people's time and expertise, not a thing	Acquisition of Services
It is a big platform with years of development ahead	Major Capability Acquisition

PATHWAYS CAN BE COMBINED

A program can prove a technology through Middle Tier rapid prototyping, then move into Major Capability Acquisition for production. Write down the reason for each move in your acquisition strategy. Future you, and future auditors, will want it.

The gates on the Major Capability pathway

Milestones are where the Milestone Decision Authority decides whether a program has earned the next phase, and the money that comes with it. Show up without the evidence and the program waits.



DECISION	WHAT GETS DECIDED	WHAT YOU BRING
MDD	A new materiel solution is needed and worth studying.	A validated requirement and a plan to compare options.
Milestone A	Which solution to pursue, and which technology risks to buy down first.	Acquisition strategy, cost estimate, draft requirement.
Milestone B	Formal program start for most big programs. The cost, schedule and performance baseline is set.	Acquisition Program Baseline (APB), systems engineering plan, test plan (TEMP), independent cost estimate.
Milestone C	Start low-rate initial production (LRIP).	Production readiness, updated test plan and baseline.
Full-Rate Production	Go to full rate once operational testing supports it.	Test results, production cost and schedule.

What changed in 2025: with JCIDS gone, your own service validates the requirement you bring, and the November 2025 memo favors competitive prototyping ahead of long analyses of alternatives. The logic is the same: earn the next phase with evidence. Plan sustainment and data rights before Milestone B, while you still have leverage.

How big is your program? The ACAT levels

CATEGORY	DOLLAR LINE	MILESTONE DECISION AUTHORITY
ACAT I (MDAP)	More than \$1B RDT&E or \$4.5B procurement, FY2024 dollars	The service acquisition executive by default (ACAT IB), or USD(A&S) when the Secretary designates it (ACAT ID). Full statutory reporting; Nunn-McCurdy applies.
ACAT II	More than \$275M RDT&E or \$1.3B procurement, FY2024 dollars	The component acquisition executive or a designee.
ACAT III	Below ACAT II	Designated by the component acquisition executive, often the PEO or PAE.
ACAT IA RETIRED	Old category for big IT programs	Repealed years ago. If a document still uses it, the document is old.

ACAT I: 10 U.S.C. 4201. ACAT II (the statutory "major system" line): 10 U.S.C. 3041. Both raised by the FY2026 NDAA (P.L. 119-60). DoDI 5000.85 still shows the older ACAT II figures (\$200M / \$920M, FY2020 dollars) until it is updated.

How close is your program to a breach?

Nunn-McCurdy is the law that tracks unit cost growth on major programs against their baseline. Think of it as a credit limit with Congress on speed dial.

BREACH	UNIT COST GROWTH	WHAT HAPPENS
Significant	15% over the current baseline, or 30% over the original	The service reports the breach to Congress with an explanation.
Critical	25% over the current baseline, or 50% over the original	The program is terminated unless the Department certifies, after a root-cause analysis, that it is essential, has no cheaper alternative and has credible new estimates. Then it is restructured.

KNOW YOUR DISTANCE IN DOLLARS

Percentages feel abstract. Work out how many dollars of unit cost growth separate your program from each line, keep it on your risk and opportunity register (R&O) with a likelihood and a weighted value, and brief it every quarter. Nobody has ever been thanked for a surprise breach.

The money behind it all

\$839.2B

FY2026 DoD appropriations, signed Feb 3, 2026

\$145.9B

of it for RDT&E

\$167.5B

of it for procurement

\$1.5T

FY2027 request, incl. \$350B via reconciliation

P.L. 119-75; CRS R48891. FY2027 had not been enacted when we checked; a CR (P.L. 119-103) runs to Dec 11, 2026.

The weapons portfolio, according to GAO

104

of DoD's costliest weapon programs assessed

\$2.4T+

planned to develop and buy them

12+ yrs

average time to deliver a capability, up again

\$49B+

across the 23 costliest Middle Tier programs

GAO, Weapon Systems Annual Assessment (GAO-26-108457), July 2, 2026.

THE PATTERN BEHIND THE NUMBERS

Programs that start with immature technology take longer and cost more, whatever the pathway. Between 2018 and 2025, 18 of 40 programs entered the Middle Tier with immature technologies. Speed comes from starting with technology that works, not from skipping the homework.

The dollar lines that come up in every meeting

Current as of 28 September 2026. Thresholds move with inflation and the NDAA, so check the date on anything you print, including this.

THRESHOLD	AMOUNT	WHY IT MATTERS, AND THE SOURCE
Micro-purchase	\$15,000	Below this, a government purchase card buy with minimal paperwork. FAC 2025-06, Oct 1, 2025 (was \$10,000).
Simplified acquisition threshold (SAT)	\$350,000	Simplified procedures up to here, and set aside for small business by default. FAC 2025-06 (was \$250,000).
Sole-source approval by the contracting officer	Up to \$900,000	Above this, a J&A needs higher approval under current FAR text (FAC 2025-06). The FY2026 NDAA raised DoD’s statutory approval tiers (sec. 1804(b)); check whether your office has implemented them.
Small business subcontracting plan	\$900,000 (\$2M construction)	Large primes above this owe a subcontracting plan. FAC 2025-06.
Certified cost or pricing data (TINA)	\$10M on DoD contracts \$2.5M elsewhere	FY2026 NDAA sec. 1804(c), for DoD contracts entered into after June 30, 2026.
Earned value management	\$50M; validated EVMS at \$100M	Cost and incentive contracts. DFARS class deviation 2026-O0011, effective Feb 1, 2026.
Expense vs. investment line	\$350,000	Decides O&M versus procurement money. Same number as the SAT, completely different rule.
O&M-funded minor construction	\$4M	10 U.S.C. 2805(c).
ACAT I / ACAT II	\$1B / \$4.5B and \$275M / \$1.3B	RDT&E / procurement lines. Page 5.

How long money can be put on contract

O&M, military personnel	1 year
RDT&E	2 years
Procurement	3 years (shipbuilding 5)
Military construction	5 years

After that, 5 years for adjustments only, then the money cancels.

Your own numbers

Continuous learning	80 CLPs every 2 years
FY2027 CR runs to	Dec 11, 2026
GAO average to deliver	Over 12 years
Nunn-McCurdy lines	15% / 25% current

GAO figure from the July 2026 Weapon Systems Annual Assessment.

The alphabet soup, with the new letters added

Fluency here is a professional baseline, not trivia. Terms marked **LEGACY** are ones you will still hear but that no longer describe how things work. Watch **UCA**: it means two very different things.

AAF Adaptive Acquisition Framework, the six pathways

ACAT Acquisition Category, set by cost

ACO Administrative Contracting Officer, runs a contract after award

ADM Acquisition Decision Memorandum, records a milestone decision

AoA Analysis of Alternatives

APB Acquisition Program Baseline, the cost, schedule and performance promise

APUC/PAUC Average Procurement Unit Cost / Program Acquisition Unit Cost, what Nunn-McCurdy watches

BES Budget Estimate Submission

CAE/SAE Component / Service Acquisition Executive

CAPE Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation, OSD's independent cost shop

CDD Capability Development Document
LEGACY

CDR/PDR Critical / Preliminary Design Review

CDRL Contract Data Requirements List, the data a contractor must deliver

CLIN Contract Line Item Number

CLP Continuous Learning Point, one per hour of training

CMMC Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification **PHASE 2 PAUSED**

CO/KO Contracting Officer, the only one who can bind the government

COR Contracting Officer's Representative, technical eyes on performance

CPD/ICD Capability Production / Initial Capabilities Document **LEGACY**

CPFF/CPIF/CPAF Cost Plus Fixed / Incentive / Award Fee

CR Continuing Resolution, last year's budget on repeat

CSO Commercial Solutions Opening, a fast way to buy innovative commercial items

CUI Controlled Unclassified Information

DAWIA Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act, governs your certification

DCAA Defense Contract Audit Agency, audits contractor costs

DCMA Defense Contract Management Agency, oversees contractor performance

DFARS Defense FAR Supplement, DoD's extra rules

DoDI DoD Instruction

DoW Department of War, the name DoD also uses since Sept 2025

EMD Engineering and Manufacturing Development, the phase after Milestone B

EAC Estimate at Completion, what the whole job will really cost

EVM/EVMS Earned Value Management / its System (\$50M / \$100M)

FAR Federal Acquisition Regulation, being rewritten (see RFO)

FFP Firm Fixed Price, the contractor carries the cost risk

FRP Full-Rate Production

FYDP Future Years Defense Program, the five-year spending plan

ICE Independent Cost Estimate

IMS/IMP Integrated Master Schedule / Plan

IPMDAR Integrated Program Management Data and Analysis Report, replaced the CPR and IPMR

IPT Integrated Product Team

J&A Justification and Approval, the paperwork for a sole-source award

JCIDS Joint Capabilities Integration and Development System **ENDED AUG 2025**

JROC Joint Requirements Oversight Council, now ranks joint operational problems

KOP Key Operational Problem, what the JROC ranks

KPP / KSA Key Performance Parameter / Key System Attribute, the must-haves and should-haves

LRIP Low-Rate Initial Production

MCA Major Capability Acquisition pathway

MDA Milestone Decision Authority

MDAP Major Defense Acquisition Program, ACAT I

MDD Materiel Development Decision

MEIA Mission Engineering and Integration Activity

MPT Micro-Purchase Threshold, \$15,000

MTA Middle Tier of Acquisition, rapid prototyping or fielding

MVCR Minimum Viable Capability Release, the first software release that goes to users

NDA National Defense Authorization Act, the yearly policy law

Nunn-McCurdy The unit cost breach law (page 6)

O&M / O&S Operation and Maintenance money / Operating and Support costs

OSD Office of the Secretary of Defense

OT / OTA Other Transaction / Other Transaction Authority, agreements outside the FAR and DFARS (some statutes still apply)

PAE Portfolio Acquisition Executive, what PEOs are becoming

PEO Program Executive Officer

PM Program Manager, not project manager: more authority, more heat

POM Program Objective Memorandum, a service's five-year budget plan

PPBE Planning, Programming, Budgeting and Execution

PWS / SOW / SOO Performance Work Statement / Statement of Work / Statement of Objectives

R&O Risk and Opportunity register, each item with a likelihood and a weighted dollar value

RDT&E Research, Development, Test and Evaluation money

RFO Revolutionary FAR Overhaul, the FAR rewrite under EO 14275

RFP / RFI Request for Proposal / Request for Information

RMD Resource Management Decision, replaced the PBD

RRAB Requirements and Resourcing Alignment Board

SAT Simplified Acquisition Threshold, \$350,000

S-CAT Services Category, how big a services buy is

SEP Systems Engineering Plan

SPRS Supplier Performance Risk System, where contractor cyber scores live

SWP Software Acquisition Pathway

TEMP Test and Evaluation Master Plan

TINA Truth in Negotiations Act, certified cost or pricing data

TMRR Technology Maturation and Risk Reduction, the phase after Milestone A

TRL Technology Readiness Level, 1 (idea) to 9 (proven in operations)

UCA Urgent Capability Acquisition, or Uninitialized Contract Action (see below)

UEI Unique Entity Identifier, a company's ID in SAM.gov (replaced DUNS)

USD(A&S) Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition and Sustainment

WarU Warfighting Acquisition University, formerly DAU

WAS Warfighting Acquisition System, the Nov 2025 overhaul

Same letters, different meaning

UCA

The pathway (Urgent Capability Acquisition) or a contract started before the price is agreed (Uninitialized Contract Action). The second one is the expensive one.

PM

Program Manager, not project manager. More authority, more heat.

CR

A continuing resolution in budget meetings, a change request in engineering ones.

TO

A task order under an IDIQ, or an Air Force technical order (a maintenance manual).

KO

The contracting officer. Not a knockout, although a bad day with one can feel like it.

ACRONYM DISCIPLINE

When you hit an unfamiliar acronym, check the document's own abbreviation list first, then the governing instruction. Never guess from civilian usage. And if you are presenting, spell it out the first time. The most senior person in the room is often the one who quietly doesn't know it either.

The concepts new PMs trip on, in plain English

Use these to learn a concept, and to explain it to the next new person on your team. Teaching it is how you find out whether you really know it.

REQUIREMENTS, AFTER JCIDS

It used to be one bouncer at the door for the whole club. Now each service checks its own guest list, and the Joint Staff decides which parties matter most for the whole building.

PPBE

Planning a wedding two years out. You book the venue long before you know the guest count, and by the big day the money is committed. The only question left is whether you spend it well.

COLOR OF MONEY

Envelopes of cash, each legally sealed to one purpose. The rent envelope cannot buy groceries, even when it is full. RDT&E builds something new, procurement buys the finished thing, O&M keeps the lights on. Mixing them up can be an Antideficiency Act violation, and those are personal.

CONTINUING RESOLUTION

Running the household on last year's budget. You can keep paying the bills you already had, but you cannot sign up for anything new, and the new car waits.

THE SIX PATHWAYS

A highway with six lanes to the same destination: a capability in users' hands. Major Capability is the heavy-truck lane, slow and inspected. Software is the express lane with frequent exits. The wrong lane for your cargo is how programs sit in traffic they never needed.

NUNN-MCCURDY

A credit limit with Congress on speed dial. Go 15% over and they get a call. Go 25% over and the card gets cut up unless someone very senior vouches for you.

UNDEFINITIZED CONTRACT ACTION

A restaurant with no prices on the menu. You are starving (the mission is urgent), so you order everything, and then you try to negotiate the bill after you have eaten. That is why these need tight limits and a fast push to a final price.

DCAA VS. DCMA

DCAA is the accountants who check the money math. DCMA is the contract managers who check the contractor delivers what was promised. Number problem, call DCAA. Delivery, schedule or quality problem, call DCMA.

TINA

Showing your receipts. On big sole-source deals (above \$10M on DoD contracts) the contractor certifies that the cost data behind its price is current, accurate and complete. If a receipt turns out to be wrong, the price comes down.

EARNED VALUE

A road trip where you watch the fuel gauge and the map at the same time. Fuel burned tells you one thing, miles covered another. Earned value compares both with where you planned to be, so you hear about the detour before you run out of gas.

How acquisition careers are built, and your first 90 days

Your acquisition career is governed by DAWIA and supported by WarU. Since the "Back-to-Basics" reforms, certification is simpler: a core certification in your functional area, then credentials for specific skills, then continuous learning to stay current.

The rules that follow you

Continuous learning	80 CLPs every 2 years. One CLP is one hour of training.
PM certification	Practitioner at about 4 years of experience, Advanced at about 8, per WarU's program management fact sheet.
Where it is tracked	Your component's learning system. Training outside WarU can be self-reported as external training. Your supervisor decides whether it counts.
Where to look	WarU (waru.edu), your component's acquisition career manager, your supervisor.

Skills that get people promoted

- **Money:** read a budget, know your color of money, explain your EAC.
- **Contracts:** know what your contract actually says and who can change it.
- **Risk:** keep a live R&O and brief it as dollars, not adjectives.
- **Data:** read an IPMDAR without waiting for someone to summarize it.
- **People:** keep your users, sponsor, CO and contractor PM in the loop before there is a problem.

Your first 90 days on a program

- ☐ Read the APB and write down your distance to each Nunn-McCurdy line in dollars.
- ☐ Read the contract, not the summary of the contract. Note the type, the CLINs and the CDRLs.
- ☐ Meet your contracting officer, COR, cost lead and financial manager in your first two weeks.
- ☐ Find out which FAR overhaul deviations your contracting office has adopted.
- ☐ Get access to the IPMDAR or your program's earned value tool.
- ☐ Learn your program's colors of money and when each one expires.
- ☐ Ask where your program sits in the current POM, and what the CR means for it.
- ☐ Walk the IMS critical path with your schedule lead.
- ☐ Open the R&O. If it has no dollar values, that is your first project.
- ☐ Meet the users. They are the reason any of this exists.

WHERE WE FIT

Every Acqlerate module ends in a Certificate of Completion that lists the hours, completion date, DAWIA functional areas and a verification ID. You can self-report it as external training toward your CLPs, and your supervisor decides whether it counts. It is not a DAWIA certification and does not replace WarU certification training.

Learn these the cheap way

None of these is exotic. They show up in program after program, because the job teaches them by pain unless someone warns you first. Consider yourself warned.

1 Treating the schedule as a report instead of a tool

A schedule that shows green while the program is amber doesn't protect you. It moves the bad news to the milestone review, where it is more expensive and more public.

Do instead: hold a weekly schedule scrub with your IPT leads, work the critical path, and never let the IMS drift more than one reporting cycle from reality.

2 Not knowing your breach distance, or your real EAC

Many new PMs have never worked out their Nunn-McCurdy lines in dollars, and brief one EAC number as if it were a fact.

Do instead: keep an R&O with a likelihood and weighted value on every item, and brief the EAC as a range: worst, likely and best. Opportunities can be netted against risks in the forecast, but only a risk that is actually retired comes off the list.

3 Reading earned value one number at a time

A CPI of 0.92 trending up for three months may be fine. The same CPI trending down is a program in trouble.

Do instead: read trends, and compare the to-complete index (TCPI) with the CPI the team is really getting. EVM applies from \$50M and a validated system from \$100M. Below that, ask how the numbers are produced before you trust them.

4 Writing requirements nobody can test

"Highly reliable" and "user friendly" become arguments, then change orders, then claims. With JCIDS gone, your own service validates the requirement, so there is less excuse for leaving it fuzzy.

Do instead: give every key performance parameter a test method, a threshold and an objective value. If nobody can write the test, rewrite the requirement before it reaches the contract.

5 Waiting for a problem before talking to stakeholders

Your stakeholders include your PEO or PAE, the users, your service's requirements owner, CAPE, the comptroller, congressional staff and the contractor's PM.

Do instead: build a stakeholder plan in week one and keep it as current as your schedule. People support what they saw coming.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

This kit is the map. Acqlerate is the drive.

Acqlerate teaches defense acquisition in short lessons built on real program numbers: **14 modules, 124 lessons** and about 45 hours of instruction, in five families. Each lesson comes at three depths and ends with a quiz. Module 1 is free, including the lesson on working through the FAR overhaul.

FOUNDATIONS How the system works, end to end DoD Acquisitions Foundations (free) From Need to RFP: Government Pre-Award Beyond Award: Sustainment and Closeout The Startup On-Ramp Why the Rules Exist	MONEY Where the dollars come from and go Defense Finance and Budgeting The Business of Defense Contracting	CONTRACTS The rules and paperwork that bind Defense Contracting Fundamentals The Compliance Stack	WINNING WORK Going after work and landing it Capture Management and BD Small Business in Defense Contracting Veteran Transition	RUN THE PROGRAM Executing once you have it Data Analytics for PMs PM Operations and Leadership
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Bold modules are where most government PMs start.

LISTEN Every module has The Debrief, an audio episode for the commute.	PROVE IT Quizzes after every lesson and a module check that unlocks the next depth level.	GET THE CREDIT A certificate for each finished module, 44.6 CLPs across the course.
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Built to stick, not just to finish

Most training is built to be finished once. Acqlerate is built to be opened daily: a two-minute daily challenge, streaks, XP, and a level road that runs from Project Coordinator to Vice President. Five minutes a day beats a two-week course you forget by Friday.

Start with Module 1. It's free.

No card, no class schedule. A lesson fits between meetings. Share this kit with the next new person on your team.

acqlerate.com

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